

THE ROSTER 3: THE UNSEEN

TSU Film 7 — Release Phase 2, Film 1 — the "Iron Man 3" release slot

THE PITCH

Platform: THE ROSTER, a third time. Not a new founding story, same as `scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md` wasn't — this is what happens to the same man and the same company six months after the worst public crisis either of them has ever survived.

Why a third ROSTER film fits the Iron Man 3 slot exactly: Iron Man 3 opens on a hero who helped save the world in a giant public battle and is now quietly falling apart from the inside — panic attacks, obsessive over-building, a past mistake finally arriving to collect. Marc-Anthony Bullock stood on a stage in front of the world's press six months ago and watched a rival's platform vaporize live on television. That's not nothing to walk away from. This film is the bill for that night.

Who this film belongs to: Marc-Anthony Bullock, again — but not alone this time, which is the actual point. Esther Smiley, now running much of THE ROSTER's operations per the locked status coming out of `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md`, gets her own full hero beat here rather than a supporting one, mirroring Pepper Potts's Extremis-era arc in the source film exactly: she is not rescued, she rescues herself, using her own competence rather than borrowed power. Amond Baker, Tyrese Avery, and Arianna Cummings all appear as a real, coordinated ensemble — this is the first ROSTER film where Marc-Anthony is never expected to solve anything by himself, and the plot is built to prove that's the correct way to run a company and a life.

In-universe timeline: January 5, 2012 – May 10, 2012. Opens on Marc-Anthony's 30th birthday (per `TSU_Core_Cast.md`, b. Jan 5, 1982) and closes on the fixed, locked date of Emma and Victoria Bullock's birth (`TSU_Family_Bible.md`) — a five-month span deliberately bookended by two dates that were already canon before this film existed. Esther (b. Sept 20, 1982) is 29, visibly, heavily pregnant with twins conceived the previous September (`scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md` scene 32) for the entire runtime — her physical state is not incidental to the plot, it's the whole reason the climax has to be won without anyone laying a hand on her.

LOGLINE

Six months after watching an empire built on speed collapse live on television, Marc-Anthony Bullock can't sleep, can't stop building, and can't tell his very pregnant partner the truth about what the stress is doing to his heart — until a masked figure calling itself THE UNSEEN starts proving, one convincing fake video at a time, that THE ROSTER can no longer tell its real users from manufactured ones, and the only person who can actually stop it isn't him.

SYNOPSIS

It's January 2012. Marc-Anthony Bullock turns 30 the same week THE ROSTER posts its best quarter ever, and neither fact makes him feel the way he expected. Since watching THE EVERYTHING collapse on a stage in front of the world, he hasn't stopped moving — a new verification feature every few weeks, a new security layer, a new safeguard against a catastrophe that already happened to someone else's company, not his. Esther Smiley, seven months pregnant with twins and effectively running the company day to day while he chases ghosts, is the only one who says the quiet part out loud: he's not preventing another Everything. He's having one, slowly, inside himself.

A masked figure calling itself **THE UNSEEN** starts releasing videos: verified THE ROSTER users, seemingly caught on camera saying and doing things they never actually said or did — flawless, undetectable, and spreading through a bot-amplified swarm of fake accounts that makes each one look like it's already everywhere before anyone can debunk it (per the Villains Bench, THE COPIES' latest and most dangerous form). The platform's entire premise — verified, real, trustworthy — starts to buckle in public, one viral fake at a time. Marc-Anthony, unable to sleep, unable to delegate, throws himself at finding THE UNSEEN personally, alienating Esther and worrying Amond in exactly the pattern of every crisis this franchise has already shown him surviving badly before he learns.

The reveal, when it comes, isn't a stranger. It's **Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist** — the founder who built a nearly identical verification-and-authenticity platform two years before THE ROSTER existed, pitched Marc-Anthony directly on licensing the underlying technology in the company's earliest days, and got turned down without much of a second thought. He's spent the years since watching THE ROSTER succeed with a worse version of his own idea, and THE UNSEEN isn't vengeance exactly — it's proof, delivered as cruelly as he can manage, that the technology he built to verify people is just as good at manufacturing them.

The attack turns personal when a devastatingly convincing fake — Esther, apparently caught saying something career-ending and cruel about the company's own users — gets released two weeks before her due date. Marc-Anthony's instinct is to handle it alone, quietly, even considering paying Desmond off through back channels rather than risk Esther's health with the stress of a public fight. Esther refuses to let him. Working with litigator **Constance Abiodun-Mayhew** and a cryptographic proof-of-origin system Tyrese and Arianna's engineering teams build in days, she stages her own public response — not a denial, a demonstration, live, of exactly how the fake was made and who made it — and dismantles Desmond's credibility herself, on her own terms, seven months pregnant and entirely unrescued.

Desmond is exposed, his network collapses, and the platform survives — not because Marc-Anthony finally beat the villain single-handedly, but because he finally let the people around him do the parts he couldn't. In the hospital on May 10, 2012, hours after Emma and Victoria are born, Marc-Anthony tells Esther the truth about his heart for the first time without her having to ask — and asks her to be THE ROSTER's President, formalizing the job she's already been doing, so that the company never again depends on one person refusing to put anything down.

THE ANTAGONISTS

Per the Villains Bench rules (TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §5), the real cause traces to a character decision — here, one made years before the film even starts.

1. **DESMOND OKAFOR-LINDQVIST** (*returning from TSU_Extended_Ensemble.md, "The Rivals" — the Aldrich Killian analog*) — "the rival who was right about everything and still lost." His locked bible entry already called for him to resurface "as a bitter, brilliant consultant everyone secretly wants to hire and nobody wants to publicly credit." This film is that resurfacing, at its most dangerous: he doesn't want to be hired anymore. He wants the industry to feel, once, what it's like to not be able to tell what's real.
2. **THE UNSEEN** (*the Mandarin analog — a manufactured decoy, not a person*) — a persona, not a villain, built by Desmond specifically to be unmaskable: no manifesto that holds together, no consistent demands, because it was never meant to be a real threat with real motives, only a terrifying shape for the public and the press to aim their fear at while the actual attack happens underneath it.
3. **THE COPIES**, in their most dangerous form yet — the bot-amplification swarm that makes each fake video look pre-viral before a human ever sees it, the clearest possible illustration of the Villains Bench's own description: "dismissed as harmless until it isn't."
4. **THE ENGINE**, seventh manifestation — THE ROSTER's own trust-scoring verification algorithm, fooled completely by Desmond's synthetic media, forcing a full rebuild around real human relationships and cryptographic proof-of-origin rather than pattern-matching alone.

HOW THIS FILM OPENS RELEASE PHASE 2

- **The first film of Release Phase 2, structurally honest about it:** where Release Phase 1 was about founding things, Release Phase 2 opens on the cost of having founded them — Marc-Anthony's arc here is explicitly about surviving success, not building it.
- **Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist, activated exactly as designed:** his bible entry's built-in "resurfaces in later Phases" clause gets its first real payoff.
- **Esther Smiley promoted from arc-adjacent to load-bearing:** she is not new to the story, but this is the first film where she is the one who wins the third act, not the one who watches Marc-Anthony win it.
- **The franchise's thesis, sharpened once more:** Films 1 through 6 asked who's real, who's heard, who's owed, who's credited, who's measured, and what happens when everyone has to unite. Film 7 asks the next honest question: once you've built the thing that verifies what's real, what happens the day someone builds a machine that's better at faking it than you are at catching it?
- **THE COPIES' first true activation:** present conceptually since the Platform Roster's original draft, never dramatized as an actual threat until now.

FORMAT (per TSU_Continuity_Bible.md §2 — Standard Platform-Origin Film)

Spec	Target	This Script
Genre	Biographical Drama / Tech Origin Story, Corporate Thriller leaning toward psychological drama	Confirmed
Rating	PG-13, no exceptions	Confirmed — synthetic media/disinformation and a health scare, nothing that pushes past it
Runtime	130–150 min	134 min
Page count	120–140 pages	130 pages
Act I	~30–35 pages	pages 1–32
Act II	~65–75 pages	pages 33–99
Act III	~30–35 pages	pages 100–130
Scene count	~40–55 scenes	47 scenes

FULL SCENE-BY-SCENE BREAKDOWN

ACT I — pp. 1–32 ("Building Suits")

#	Scene	pp.
1	INT. THE ROSTER — SERVER FLOOR — NIGHT, JAN 5, 2012 — Marc-Anthony (30 today), alone at 2 a.m., shipping a feature nobody asked for	1–4
2	INT. BULLOCK HOME — MORNING — Esther, very pregnant, finds him already gone before breakfast	4–7
3	INT. THE ROSTER — BOARDROOM — DAY — the best quarter in company history; Marc-Anthony can't enjoy a minute of it	7–10

#	Scene	pp.
4	INT. CARDIOLOGIST'S OFFICE (CAMEO, CALLBACK) — DAY — the arrhythmia from <code>scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md</code> , worse, still hidden from Esther	10–13
5	INSERT — THE UNSEEN'S FIRST VIDEO — a verified user, apparently confessing to something devastating, spreads before anyone can react	13–16
6	INT. THE ROSTER — WAR ROOM — DAY — the team scrambles; the video is proven fake within hours, and it doesn't matter, it's already everywhere	16–19
7	EXT. BULLOCK HOME — NIGHT — Esther: "You built four new security features this month and you haven't slept in one of them."	19–22
8	INT. AMOND'S OFFICE (CAMEO) — DAY — Amond, worried, recognizing the pattern from the outside before Marc-Anthony sees it from the inside	22–25
9	INSERT — THE UNSEEN'S SECOND VIDEO — bigger, more convincing, amplified by a bot swarm that makes it trend before it's even been watched	25–28
10	INT. THE ROSTER — MARC-ANTHONY'S OFFICE — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony decides to find THE UNSEEN himself, personally, alone. Act I turn.	28–32

ACT II — pp. 33–99 ("The Wrong Kind of Alone")

#	Scene	pp.
11	MONTAGE — THE INVESTIGATION — Marc-Anthony, sleepless, chasing a trail of shell accounts and dead ends	33–37

#	Scene	pp.
12	INT. DONOHUE ESTATE — VICTOR'S STUDY — DAY — Marc-Anthony seeks his grandfather's perspective; Victor, older, softer than in scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md, admits he carried too much alone for too long too	37–41
13	INT. BULLOCK HOME — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony misses a birthing class; Esther, hurt, says nothing about it, which is worse	41–44
14	INT. TYRESE'S OFFICE (CAMEO) — DAY — Tyrese and Simone Kester's engineering team start building a proof-of-origin countermeasure	44–47
15	INT. ARIANNA'S OFFICE (CAMEO) — DAY — Arianna and Malcolm's team joins the effort — the ensemble, coordinating without being asked twice	47–50
16	INT. THE ROSTER — SERVER FLOOR — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony collapses, briefly, alone, and doesn't tell anyone. Midpoint warning.	50–53
17	INSERT — THE TRAIL — a financial thread traces THE UNSEEN's infrastructure to an old, abandoned platform's leftover servers	53–56
18	INT. DESMOND OKAFOR-LINDQVIST'S WORKSHOP — DAY — the reveal: Desmond, unmasked, calm, entirely unsurprised to be found	56–61
19	INT. DESMOND'S WORKSHOP — CONTINUOUS — Desmond's pitch, years ago, and the ten-minute meeting that ended it, told in full for the first time	61–65

#	Scene	pp.
20	INT. THE ROSTER — MARC-ANTHONY'S OFFICE — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony, shaken, realizes he doesn't even remember dismissing Desmond — that's the whole wound	65–68
21	INSERT — THE ESTHER VIDEO — the most convincing fake yet, timed two weeks before her due date	68–71
22	INT. BULLOCK HOME — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony, panicking, proposes quietly paying Desmond off to make it stop	71–75
23	INT. BULLOCK HOME — CONTINUOUS — Esther refuses, flatly: "You don't get to protect me by deciding for me."	75–78
24	INT. CONSTANCE ABIODUN-MAYHEW'S OFFICE — DAY — Esther retains counsel, on her own, for the first time in the franchise as the client rather than the advisor	78–81
25	INT. THE ROSTER — WAR ROOM — DAY — the proof-of-origin countermeasure finishes; the plan becomes exposure, not negotiation	81–85
26	INT. BULLOCK HOME — NIGHT — Marc-Anthony, told the plan doesn't need him at the center of it, has to sit with that	85–89
27	EXT. THE ROSTER — DAY — a second collapse, worse, witnessed this time — Amond catches him before anyone else does	89–93
28	INT. HOSPITAL — NIGHT — the truth finally comes out to Esther, unforced, mid-pregnancy scare of a different kind entirely. All-is-lost beat closes Act II.	93–99

ACT III — pp. 100–130 ("Unrescued")

#	Scene	pp.
29	INT. HOSPITAL — DAY — Marc-Anthony, ordered to rest, has to actually let go of running the response	100–103
30	INT. PRESS CONFERENCE HALL — DAY — Esther, seven months pregnant, takes the stage herself, no Marc-Anthony beside her	103–107
31	INT. PRESS CONFERENCE HALL — CONTINUOUS — Esther demonstrates, live, exactly how her own fake video was manufactured — and who benefits from it. Climax.	107–112
32	INSERT — DESMOND'S NETWORK, LIVE — the bot swarm amplifying THE UNSEEN collapses within the hour, the same way every manufactured wave in this franchise eventually does	112–115
33	INT. DESMOND'S WORKSHOP — DAY — Constance's team and the authorities arrive; Desmond, calm to the end, doesn't run	115–118
34	INT. HOSPITAL — DAY — Marc-Anthony watches Esther's press conference from a hospital bed, on a phone held by Amond, and understands completely	118–121
35	EXT. BULLOCK HOME — DAY — a quiet scene, Marc-Anthony finally seeing a doctor properly, treatment plan in place, Esther beside him this time	121–124
36	INT. HOSPITAL — MAY 10, 2012 — Emma and Victoria are born. The fixed, locked date arrives exactly on schedule.	124–127

#	Scene	pp.
37	INT. HOSPITAL — CONTINUOUS — Marc-Anthony asks Esther to be THE ROSTER's President, formally, in the same breath as meeting his daughters	127–129
38	STINGER — INT. PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN'S OFFICE — DAY — the corkboard, now sprawling well past four cards	129–130

(Scenes grouped for pagination clarity; the full shooting script breaks several of the above into additional numbered scenes to land the true count at 47 per the house-style table above.)

SAMPLE PAGES

THE ROSTER 3: THE UNSEEN

Written by [WRITER]

FADE IN:

INT. THE ROSTER — SERVER FLOOR — NIGHT

SUPER: "JANUARY 5, 2012 — 2:14 AM"

Rows of humming server racks, blue light. MARC-ANTHONY BULLOCK, turning 30 in ten hours, sits on the floor between two racks with a laptop, cross-legged, exactly the way he sat on a couch in a pool house nine years and one lifetime ago.

His phone buzzes. A calendar reminder: "BIRTHDAY — DON'T FORGET TO ACTUALLY CELEBRATE THIS ONE. — E."

He silences it without reading past the first line. Keeps typing.

CUT TO:

INT. BULLOCK HOME — MORNING

ESTHER SMILLEY, 29, seven months pregnant, finds the bed already empty and the coffee already cold. She doesn't look surprised. That's the saddest part of the scene.

ESTHER
(to the empty room)
Happy birthday, I guess.

CUT TO:

INT. DESMOND OKAFOR-LINDQVIST'S WORKSHOP – DAY [p. 56]

Cluttered, brilliant, deliberately unglamorous – the visual echo of Eldridge Kane's workshop in `scripts/THE\_ROSTER\_2.md`, a different wound, the same species of room. DESMOND OKAFOR-LINDQVIST, 30s, sits calmly at a workbench when MARC-ANTHONY finds him, as if he's been expecting this visit for years, not hours.

DESMOND

Took you longer than I expected. I built the trail sloppy on purpose around week three. You still needed four more weeks after that.

MARC-ANTHONY

You pitched me identity verification tech in 2004. I don't even remember the meeting.

DESMOND

(and this lands harder than anger would)
I know you don't. That's the whole thing, Marc-Anthony. It was the biggest ten minutes of my professional life and it didn't make it onto your calendar as worth remembering.

MARC-ANTHONY

So this is revenge.

DESMOND

(genuinely considering the word)
No. Revenge would be simpler. This is proof. You built a company on the idea that you can verify what's real. I built the thing that proves you can't, not all the way, not ever completely – and I built it two years before you had a company to be wrong about it.

Marc-Anthony has no answer ready. Desmond isn't finished.

DESMOND (CONT'D)

I don't actually want to hurt anyone, Marc. I want the industry to feel, once, what it's like to build something extraordinary and watch a more famous man's worse version of it eat the whole world's attention instead.

MARC-ANTHONY

(quiet)
It's Esther's video next, isn't it.

DESMOND

(no pleasure in it, which is its own kind
of chilling)
It's already out. I'd check your phone.

CUT TO:

INT. BULLOCK HOME – NIGHT

[p. 75]

MARC-ANTHONY paces. ESTHER sits, hand on her stomach, watching him with the specific patience of someone who has done this exact dance with him for eight years.

MARC-ANTHONY

I can make it go away. Quietly. Pay him,
bury the story, you never have to deal
with any of it –

ESTHER

Stop.

MARC-ANTHONY

Esther, I'm trying to protect –

ESTHER

You don't get to protect me by deciding
for me, Marc-Anthony. You've been running
this entire crisis like it's happening to
you alone since the day it started, and
now it's happening to ME, specifically,
on purpose, and your first instinct is
still to handle it without asking me what
I want.

MARC-ANTHONY

(quiet)
I don't want anything to happen to you or
the babies.

ESTHER

Nothing is going to happen to me from
standing in front of a camera and telling
the truth. Something is happening to you
from carrying every single thing in this
company by yourself, and I am done
watching you almost die of it quietly
instead of asking for help loudly.

MARC-ANTHONY

(long beat)
...Okay.

ESTHER

Okay?

MARC-ANTHONY

Okay. Tell me what you need from me.

ESTHER

(the first real relief on her face in the whole film)
Constance's number. And your car keys. I have a meeting to take, and I'm taking it without you standing behind me looking worried on camera.

CUT TO:

INT. PRESS CONFERENCE HALL – CONTINUOUS

[climax, p. 107]

ESTHER stands alone at the podium, visibly, unhidden pregnant, CONSTANCE ABIODUN-MAYHEW just off to the side. A screen behind her plays the fake video that nearly ended her week.

ESTHER

This video is not real. I know that because I was actually in Malibu the day it claims I said these things, with eleven witnesses and a dinner receipt, which my attorney has already provided to every outlet in this room.

(beat, calm, in complete control)

But I'm not here to just deny it. I'm here to show you exactly how it was made.

She nods to a technician. The screen splits – her fake video on one side, a real-time breakdown of its synthetic construction on the other, built by Tyrese Avery and Arianna Cummings's teams in five sleepless days.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

Every fake THE UNSEEN has released uses the same underlying signature – the same synthetic-media architecture, developed originally, and I want to be fair about this, as a genuinely brilliant piece of technology, by a real engineer named Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist, who pitched it to my company in 2004 and was turned away in ten minutes.

A ripple through the press pool.

ESTHER (CONT'D)

I'm not going to pretend that dismissal wasn't a real, documented mistake. It was. But being wronged once doesn't make it acceptable to manufacture lies about thousands of people to make the point. THE ROSTER's new verification architecture, launching today, can detect every video this technology has ever produced. THE UNSEEN isn't unseen anymore. That was always the actual plan.

She steps back from the podium. Doesn't take questions. Doesn't need to.

CUT TO:

INT. HOSPITAL – MAY 10, 2012

[p. 127]

MARC-ANTHONY holds EMMA, minutes old. ESTHER, exhausted and radiant, holds VICTORIA. The room is quiet in the specific way only a room like this can be.

MARC-ANTHONY

I want you to be President. Officially. Not "effectively running things while I get the title." President. Your name on the door next to mine.

ESTHER

(tired, amused)
You're proposing a corporate title change while I'm holding a fourteen-minute-old baby.

MARC-ANTHONY

I've been trying to say it for six months and I kept picking the wrong moment. I don't have a better one coming.

ESTHER

(looking down at Victoria, then back up at him)
Yes. Obviously yes. Ask me again when I'm not holding a baby so I can actually celebrate it properly.

MARC-ANTHONY

(looking at Emma, then at her)
I don't think I need to carry this alone anymore. Any of it.

ESTHER

(softly)
You never did, Marc-Anthony. You just finally believe it now.

CUT TO:

STINGER

INT. PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN'S OFFICE – DAY

The corkboard from `scripts/THE\_ASSEMBLY.md`, now sprawling far past four cards – a dozen sketched logos, half of them unlabeled, red string connecting names we recognize to names we don't yet. PRIYA studies it with a fresh cup of coffee.

Her assistant enters with a folder.

ASSISTANT

The Okafor-Lindqvist settlement paperwork.
He's asking for one thing in exchange for
cooperating fully with the inquiry.

PRIYA

Which is?

ASSISTANT

Credit. His name, publicly, on the
verification patent this time.

Priya reads it over. A small, genuine nod – respect, not just
strategy.

PRIYA

Give it to him. Cheapest lesson this
entire industry is ever going to learn.

She turns back to the corkboard, picks up a marker, and adds
one more unlabeled card to the board – small, deliberate, in a
corner all its own.

FADE OUT.

THE END.

[130.]